

Islam In Two Words

إن الحمد لله نحمده ونستعينه ونستغفره، ونعوذ بالله من شرور أنفسنا، ومن سيئات أعمالنا، من يهده الله فلا مضل له، ومن يضلل فلا هادي له، وأشهد أن لا إله إلا الله وحده لا شريك له، وأشهد أن سيدنا محمداً عبده ورسوله، اللهم صل وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه ومن تبعه إلى يوم الدين
يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تُقَاتِهِ وَلَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ [آل عمران:102]، أما بعد
فإن أصدق الحديث كتاب الله، وأحسن الهدي هدي محمد، وشر الأمر محدثاتها، وكل محدثة بدعة، وكل بدعة ضلالة، وكل ضلالة في النار

Allah has defined for us our role model:

لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ لِمَنْ كَانَ يَرْجُوا اللَّهَ وَالْيَوْمَ الْآخِرَ وَذَكَرَ اللَّهَ كَثِيرًا (الأحزاب)
“Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent role model for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah much.” (Al-Aḥzāb 33:21)

There are many aspects of the Prophet’s ﷺ character that we should follow. Today I will focus on one that I hope every khatib, including myself, will practice: **brevity**.

If I speak at great length about the importance of being brief, I will be contradicting my own message.

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ taught us that the power of speech is not measured by its length, and that wisdom is not in the number of words we use, but by choosing the right words and putting them in the right place. The Prophet ﷺ said:

«إِنَّ طُولَ صَلَاةِ الرَّجُلِ، وَقِصَرَ خُطْبَتِهِ، مِثْنَةٌ مِنْ فِقْهِهِ»
A man’s lengthy prayer and short khutbah are a sign of his understanding.”
(Sahih Muslim)

And Jabir ibn Samurah رضي الله عنه described the prayer and khutbah of the Prophet ﷺ by saying:

«كَانَتْ صَلَاتُهُ قَصْدًا، وَخُطْبَتُهُ قَصْدًا»
“His prayer was moderate, and his khutbah was moderate.” (Sahih Muslim)

The purpose of the Friday khutbah is not for the khatib to say everything he knows but to say what people need to hear. There is a big difference between the two.

You may know a great deal about a subject, but wisdom requires you to ask:

- What is the one idea I want people to leave with today?
- And what is the clearest and shortest way of communicating it?

We often fall into the trap of overexplaining: we state an idea, then explain it, then repeat the explanation in another way, then add examples and explanations of the examples. Meanwhile, the listener may have understood the point several minutes ago.

Sometimes excessive explanation weakens the argument. Too much justification may suggest that you do not trust the listener's understanding, or that you yourself are not confident in the strength of what you are saying.

Wisdom is not found in the abundance of words.

Wisdom is knowing when to speak, what to say, and when to stop.

The Prophet ﷺ described one of the special gifts Allah gave him:

«بُعِثْتُ بِجَوَامِعِ الْكَلِمِ»

“I was sent with comprehensive speech expressed in few words.” (Agreed upon)

Jawami' al-kalim means the ability to express great meanings in few words.

This is a lesson for all of us, not only for khatibs. If an idea is already clear, do not let an excess of words blur that clarity.

If a matter requires evidence, do not give ten proofs when one clear verse or one authentic hadith is enough.

If something needs explanation, explain it. But when it does not, stop.

Brevity is not a sign of lack of knowledge. Often, it is a sign of maturity of knowledge.

When an idea is not yet clear in our own minds, we may need pages to explain it. But when we truly understand it, we can often express its essence in a single sentence.

So let us apply this principle now. Suppose someone asked me: **“Can you summarize the message of Islam in just two words?”**

At first, the question may seem impossible. The Qur'an contains more than six thousand verses. Islam encompasses belief, worship, morality, law, human relationships, family, society, and much more. How could all of this possibly be summarized in two words?

I will try. I would say: **Knowledge and Accountability**. And to support this, I will not give you a lecture. I will give only two verses. One from the beginning of the revelation and one from the end of revelation.

The first words revealed to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) were:

﴿اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ ﴿اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ﴾ الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ ﴿

“Read in the name of your Lord who created. He created the human being from a clinging substance. Read, and your Lord is the Most Generous, who taught by the pen, taught the human being what he did not know.” (Al-'Alaq 96:1–5)

Read...taught by the pen...taught the human being what he did not know. So, the journey begins with: **Knowledge.**

Human beings cannot fulfill their purpose in this life without knowledge. But is knowledge enough? No. Because knowledge without responsibility can be dangerous.

So now let us look at the other end of the journey. Many scholars identified this verse as the last revealed:

﴿وَاتَّقُوا يَوْمًا تُرْجَعُونَ فِيهِ إِلَى اللَّهِ ثُمَّ تُوَفَّى كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَا كَسَبَتْ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ﴾

“And be mindful of a Day when you will be returned to Allah. Then every soul will be paid in full for what it has earned, and none will be wronged.” (Al-Baqarah 2:281)

The journey began with: ﴿اقْرَأْ﴾, **“Read”**, and it ends with: ﴿تُرْجَعُونَ فِيهِ إِلَى اللَّهِ﴾, **“You will be returned to Allah.”** At the beginning: Learn. At the end: You will be asked what you did with what you learned. **Knowledge and Accountability.**

Between these two words lies the journey of human life: learn what Allah asks of you, distinguish truth from falsehood, understand your responsibility toward Allah, your family, people, and society.

And remember that you will return to Allah, and that your knowledge, actions, wealth, time, and abilities all carry responsibility.

At this point, I could add many verses and hadiths. But I will not. Because today's khutbah is about **brevity**, and the point has been made.

أقول قولي هذا واستغفر الله العظيم لي ولكم ولسائر المسلمين من كل ذنب فاستغفروه إنه هو الغفور الرحيم

الحمد لله وأشهد أن لا إله إلا الله وحده لا شريك له ، وأشهد أن سيدنا محمدًا عبده ورسوله ، صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه ومن سار على نهجهم واهتدى بهديهم .أما بعد: .عباد الله: أوصيكم ونفسي بتقوى الله

Perhaps we can leave today with three words: **Learn. Act. Account.**

Learn what is right. Act upon what you know. And remember that you will give an account before Allah.

We ask Allah to teach us what benefits us, to benefit us through what He has taught us, and to make our knowledge an argument for us and not against us.

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اللهم صلّ وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه
اللهم اهدنا فيمن هديت ، وعافنا فيمن عافيت ، وتولنا فيمن توليت ، وبارك لنا فيما أعطيت ، وقنا
واصرف عنا شر ما قضيت ، فإنك تقضي بالحق ، ولا يقضى عليك ،
لهم وأدخلنا برحمتك في عبادك الصالحين ، أخرجنا من ظلمات الجهل والوهم إلى أنوار العلم
اللهم اجعلنا ممن يستمعون القول فيتبعون أحسنه
اللهم بفضلك ورحمتك أعل كلمة الحق والدين ، وانصر الإسلام ، وأعز المسلمين يا أكرم الأكرمين .

O Allah, spread your mercy upon us, shower us with Your blessings, increase our knowledge, grant us forgiveness, and reward us by the company of Your prophets in the highest place in Heaven, Al-Ferdous Al-Aala.

O Allah, forgive our parents and all our friends and relatives who have passed away and make their graves a garden from heaven and grant them the Ferdous Al-Ala.

O Allah, remedy our sick and grant them full and speedy recovery.

O Allah, guide our children, protect them and make them righteous.

O Allah we have many of our brethren who are suffering from injustice and oppression, O Allah grant them victory, heal their trauma, protect the helpless, fulfill their needs and grant them peace and prosperity.

O Allah, we ask you in this blessed hour with every name you have elected for yourself that none of us leave this gathering, but his pains have been relieved, his worries have been removed, his debts have been paid, his weaknesses have been concealed, his sins have been forgiven, and his needs have been fulfilled,

إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَمَلَائِكَتَهُ يُصَلُّونَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا (الأحزاب 33:56)
اللهم صلّ وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه
وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ